VITALITY 13

L-citrulline

Amino acid the body converts into L-arginine, which is used to make nitric oxide



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Amino acid	Erectile dysfunction	Very small human studies	Dietary supplement; not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

Erections	With resveratrol
HUMAN + ANIMAL	HUMAN

A larger trial is recruiting. An Egyptian trial comparing L-citrulline with tadalafil, 133 men planned, began in 2026. No results yet.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

L-citrulline ▶ Becomes arginine ▶ Nitric oxide ▶ Vessels relax

- **Converted to L-arginine,** which is used to make nitric oxide
- **Raises arginine** with less breakdown in gut and liver than arginine
- **In rats,** improved erection pressure after 3 weeks (animal)
- **In people,** the mechanism for ED is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CASE REPORTS
LEVEL 2 OF 5

- 2 small human studies, 24 and 20 men
- Most other data in rats
- No Phase II or III trial results

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Side-effect profile
- Dose for ED

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	By mouth in the two studies
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Limited human data	Dietary supplement
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Erection hardness, erectile function score	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved for any use
FDA	Under evaluation for compounding (503A, 503B)
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Cormio et al., Urology, oral L-citrulline for mild ED, Jan 2011
2. Shirai et al., Sex Med, citrulline with resveratrol, Dec 2018
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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